

Operation Homecoming was the name given to the repatriation of American POWs in 1973 following the signing of the Paris Accords in January 1973. The North released the prisoners as the last remaining US forces withdrew from South Vietnam, except for a small contingent at the American embassy in Saigon. With great fanfare, the returnees were welcomed home as heroes, a reception few other service members received when they came back from the controversial war.



Going home

Newly freed prisoners of war show their joy as their military aircraft lifts off from Hanoi on February 12, 1973. Between February and April 1970, the mission dubbed Operation Homecoming returned 591 American POWs to their home country.